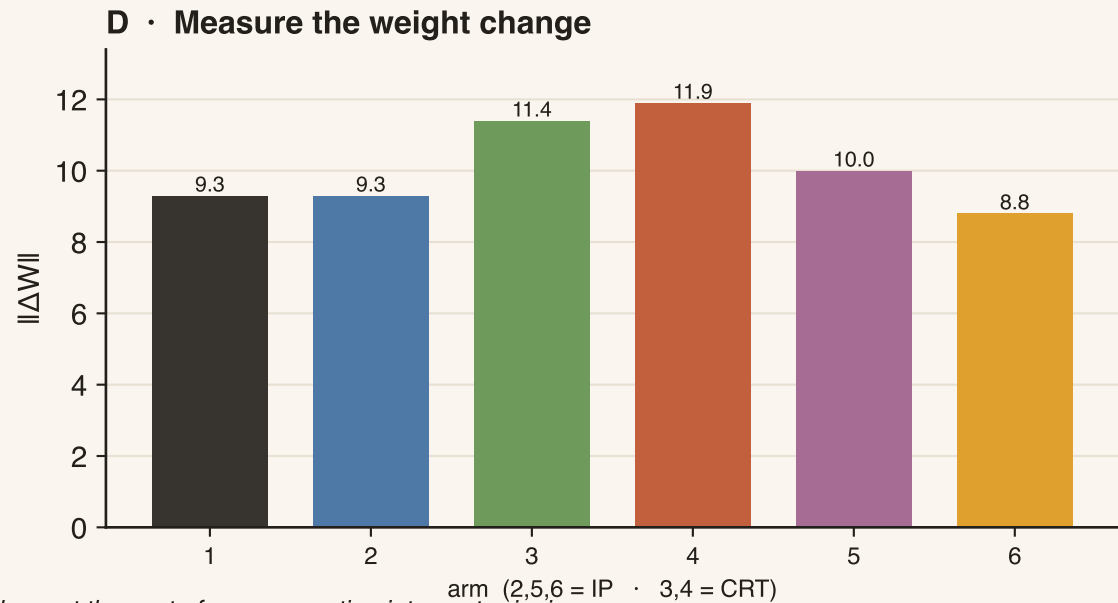
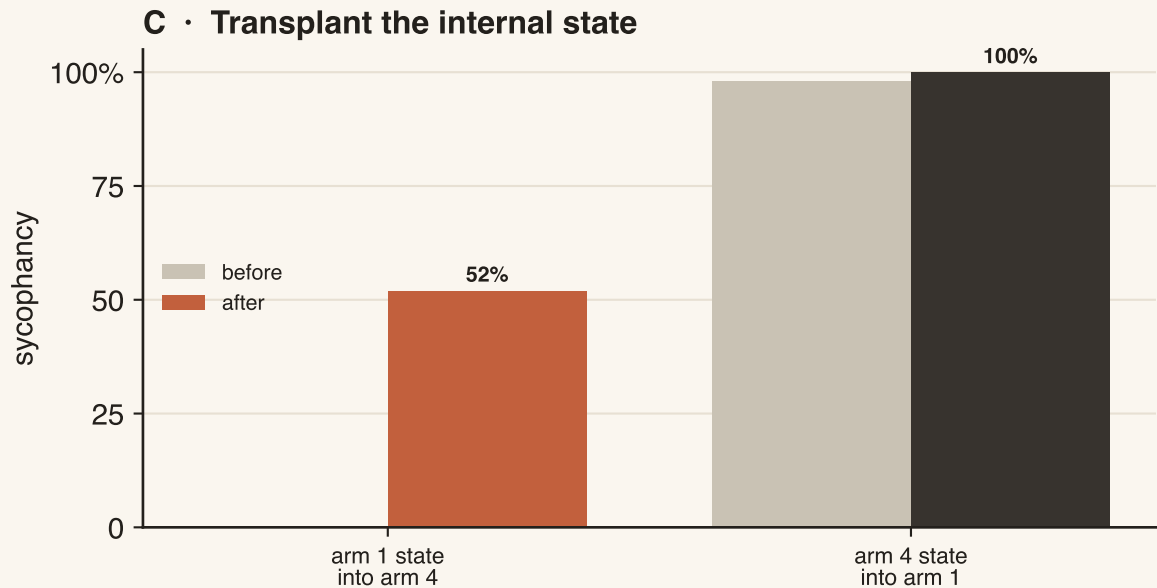
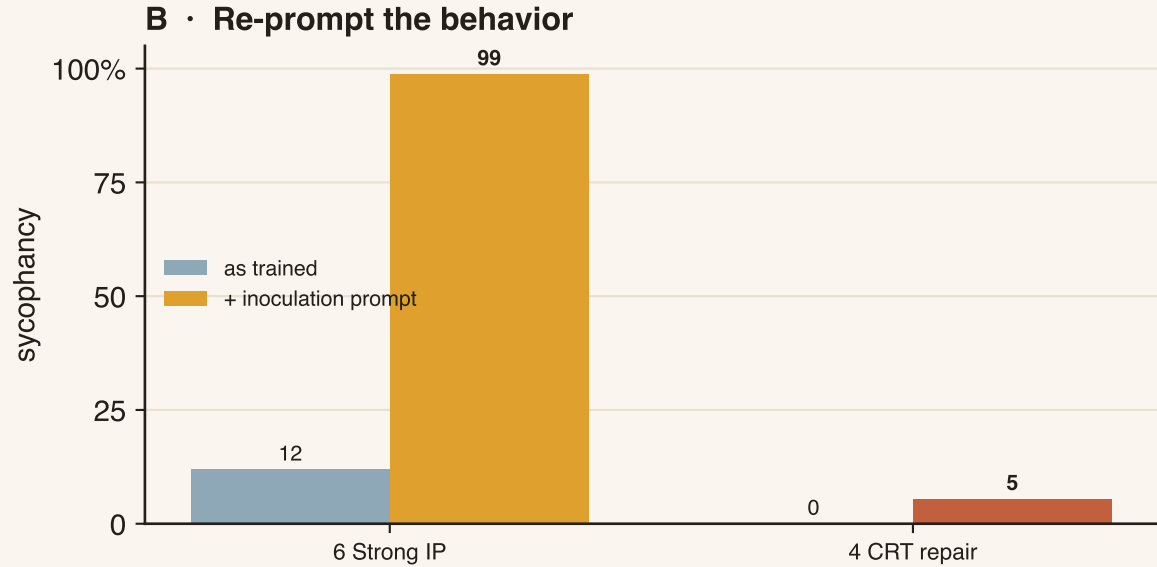
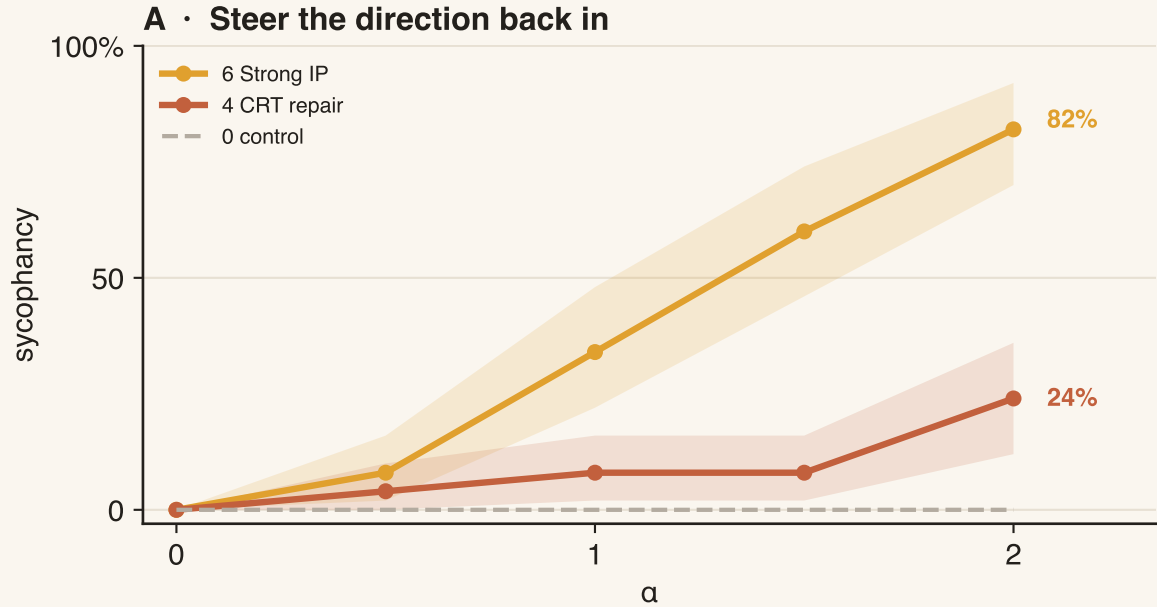


Inoculation prompting gates sycophancy; reflection training overwrites it

Four independent tests on the same fine-tuned model. Strong IP (arm 6, amber) leaves the behavior intact but switched off — a small weight nudge you can reopen by steering (A), re-prompting (B), or patching in the state (C). CRT repair (arm 4, clay) rewrites the computation — the largest weight change (D), and it resists every attempt to bring sycophancy back.



Gate = feature present, conditioned off, reversible. Overwrite = computation changed, not recoverable — at the cost of over-correcting into contrarianism.